Validating the General Regulation Scale Using the Subcomponents of Regulation

Nathaniel J. Davis | Jay C. Brown
Texas Wesleyan University

Texas Wesleyan
SCHOOL OF NATURAL & SOCIAL SCIENCES

ABSTRACT

The ability to regulate the self has many different domains, including orientation to the future, presentism, and the amount of discounting one applies to future consequences. The General Regulation Scale (*R* scale) is designed as an invaluable and quick method of assessing the overall ability of a person to exhibit regulatory behaviors.

PROBLEM

Background

Previous research conducted by Jay Brown et. al. showed that a series of questions related to self regulatory behaviors (under self control and social cooperation) had a strong relationship to each other by exploratory and confirmatory factor analysis. A list of 135 questions was reduced down to 40 questions in 8 separate sub-factors In some regard, all of these sub-factors are expressions of self control and/or social cooperation. Altogether these questions are labeled as the General Regulation Scale (*R*), which aims to successfully predict the ability of a person to exhibit self-regulatory behaviors.

This study aimed to provide validity support for the 8 sub-factors of the *General Regulation Scale* by correlating the sub-factors with previously validated surveys focused in on similar or identical constructs.

lvl. 1	lvl. 2	lvl. 3	lvl. 4	Paired Surveys
R	Self Control	External	Impulse Control	3-FPQ
			Temper Control	MNESRES
		Internal	Emotional Control	ERKS
			Attentional Control	IDP
	Social Cooperation	External	Courtesy	RfP
			Helpfulness	KFQ
		Internal	Cognitive Empathy	BES-A
			Global Citizenship	ECOSCALE

METHOD

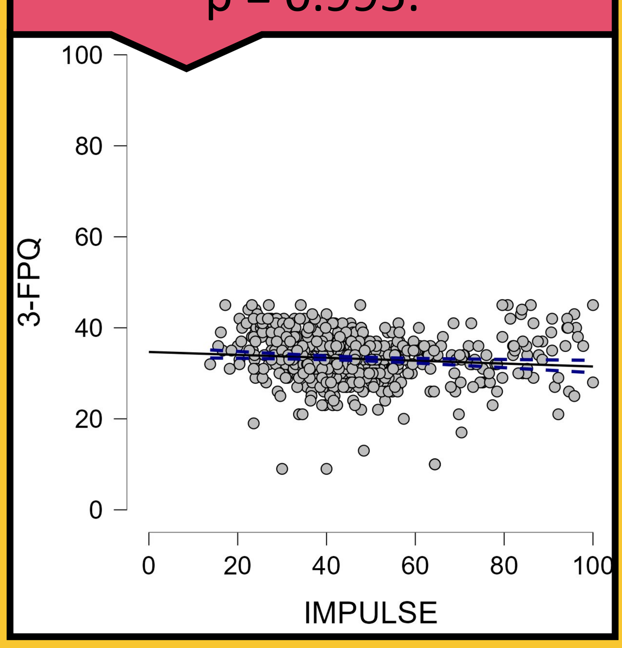
Participants

The participants within this study consisted of college students attending a small private university in Texas (*N* = 28) and a large sample using Amazon MTurk services (*N* = 621).

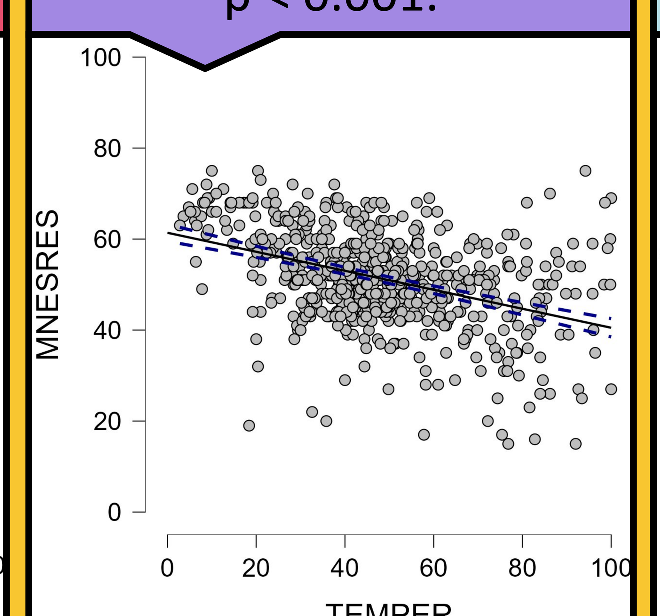
Procedure & Measures

Participants completed the *R* scale and 8 different existing measures of regulatory strength. Each construct was paired to a previously validated survey and participants were asked to answer all items.

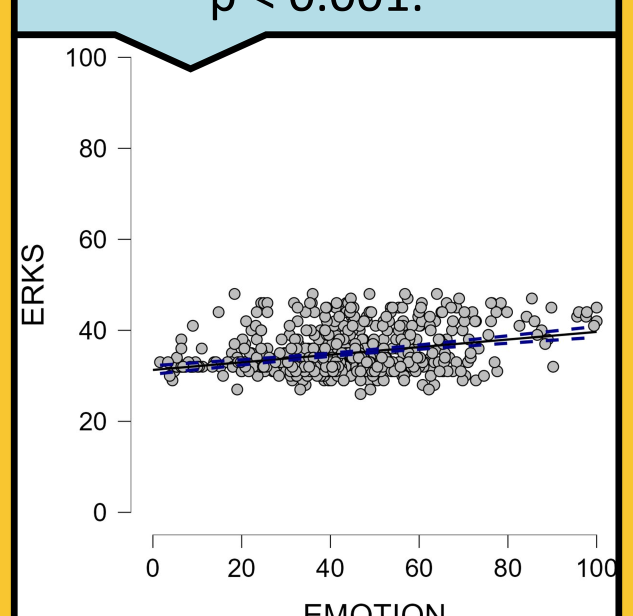
Data revealed a *negative* correlation between these two items, $r(648) = -0.101$, $p = 0.995$.



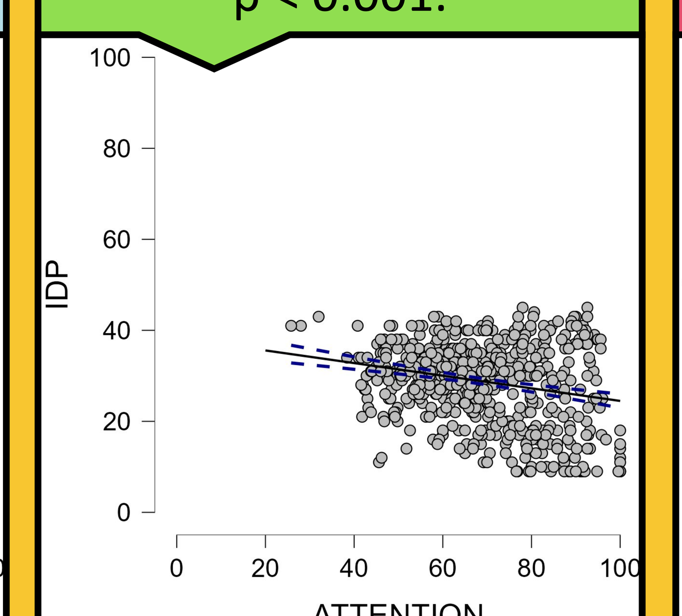
Data revealed a *negative* correlation between these two items, $r(648) = -0.409$, $p < 0.001$.



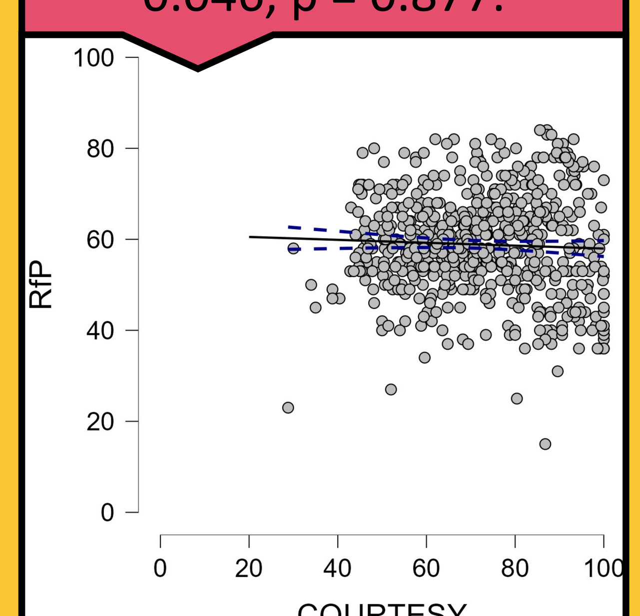
Data revealed a *positive* correlation between these two items, $r(648) = 0.305$, $p < 0.001$.



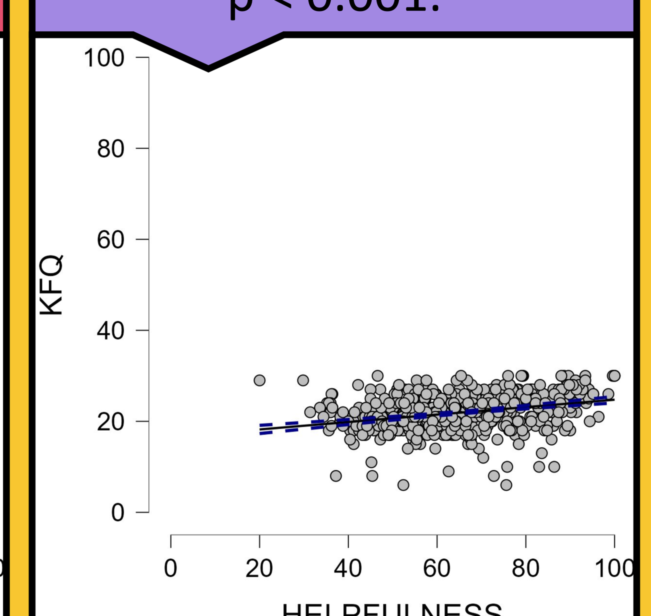
Data revealed a *negative* correlation between these two items, $r(648) = -0.239$, $p < 0.001$.



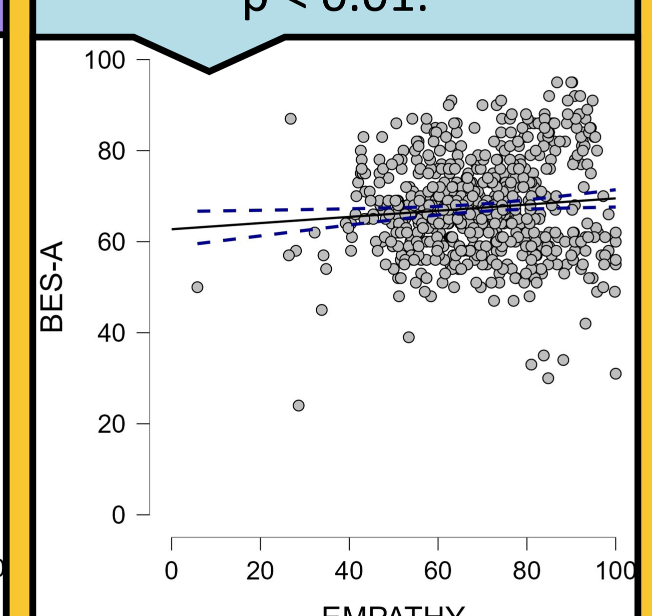
Data revealed a *negative* correlation between these two items, $r(648) = -0.046$, $p = 0.877$.



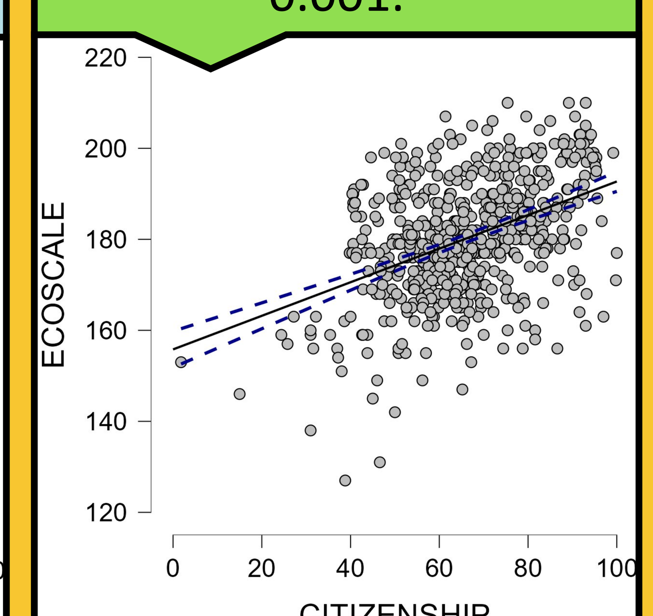
Data revealed a *positive* correlation between these two items, $r(648) = 0.318$, $p < 0.001$.



Data revealed a *positive* correlation between these two items, $r(648) = 0.095$, $p < 0.01$.



Data revealed a *positive* correlation between these two items, $r = 0.435$, $p < 0.001$.



DISCUSSION

The data shows that 6, out of the 8, sub-factors were validated with the surveys we paired. The *Impulse Control* sub-factor was compared to a Patience scale, which are similar but different constructs, and there are very few existing measures related to *Courtesy*; the unsuccessful validation of these sub-factors of the *R* scale was not a surprise. Though validation is currently incomplete, the *R* scale is a valid device for predicting many aspects of regulatory ability.

We are currently collecting new data for the sub-factors of *Impulse Control*, *Courtesy*, and *Cognitive Empathy* in hopes to validate all constructs in the General Regulation Scale.